

The background of the slide features a faint, light-brown world map centered on the Atlantic Ocean. Overlaid on the map is a grid of thin, light-brown lines. In the top-left corner, there is a circular graphic consisting of several concentric circles and radial lines, resembling a stylized compass rose or a map projection. In the bottom-right corner, there is a more detailed compass rose with a star-like center and multiple points, also overlaid on the map and grid.

The Windrush Scandal

- By Ilja Busch
- 25th of Nov. 2025

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The Commonwealth

International Association

- 56 member states
- connected through
 - same language
 - culture
 - history

Most members come stem from the former organization, the British Empire



The Commonwealth

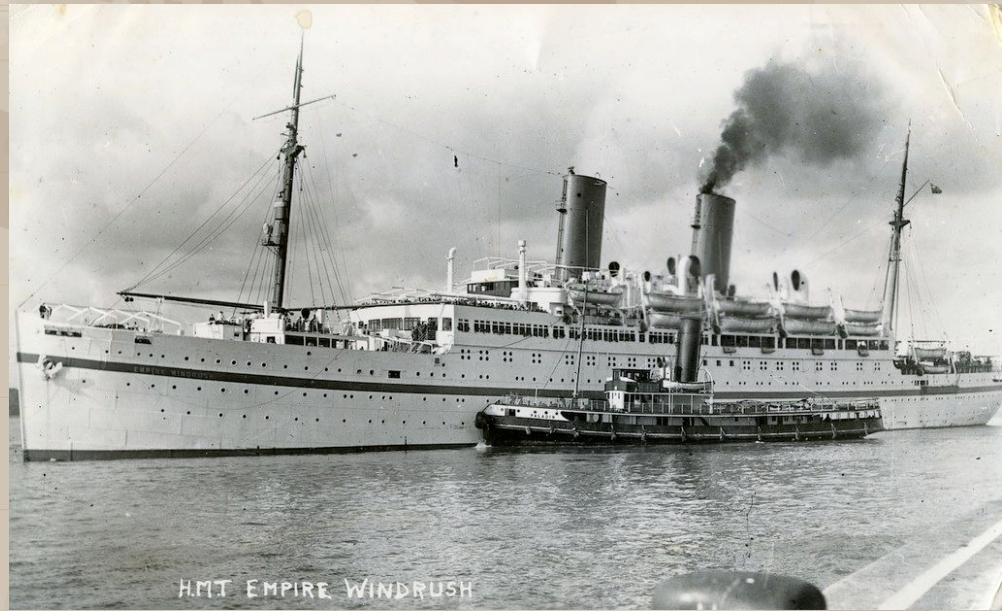


HMT Empire Windrush

A ship carrying ~ 1.000 Caribbeans from commonwealth members in the 1940s.

There were other ships, but this was the most popular one.

The namesake of the Windrush generation and subsequent scandal.



British Nationality Act 1948

Defined British nationality via the ...

„Citizens of the United Kingdom and Colonies“ (CUKC)

... status as the citizenship of the UK and its colonies.



The Windrush Generation

The people were brought to help rebuild post-war Britain.

From 1948 to the 1980s.

The HMT Empire Windrush arrived in **1948**, when the act was passed.



The Windrush Scandal

- began in 2018
- wrongfully detained
- denied legal rights
- threatened with deportation

Wrongly deported in 83 cases!

Most deportees were from the Windrush generation.

Lots of others lost their homes, jobs, ...



How did this happen?

On arrival to Britain in the 1940s, the Caribbeans received **no documents** stating their extraordinary immigration status.

The new **hostile environment** act ignored this specialty.

- it required proof of **legal status**
- aimed to make **undocumented** immigrants lives difficult

25 JUN 1948 3624 P.M. 22

Merchant Shipping Act, 1906, and Aliens Restriction Acts, 1914 and 1919.

IN-COMING PASSENGERS

Returns of Passengers brought to the United Kingdom in ships arriving from Places out of Europe, and not within the Mediterranean Sea.

Notes (a)—All Passengers brought by such ships are to be included, whether arriving from Europe or from any other place. 1st Class, 2nd Class, Tourist Class, and 3rd Class Passengers are to be entered in separate groups.

(b)—In the case of those ships which are engaged in pleasure cruises starting and ending in the United Kingdom the full particulars required by this form should only be furnished in respect of those passengers who embark at a port abroad and disembark in the United Kingdom.

Ship's Name	Official Number	Shipping Line	Registered Tonnage	Master's Name	Voyage
N.Y. "EMPIRE VISITOR"	181951.	THE NEW ZEALAND SHIPPING CO., LTD., 138, LEADHILL STREET, LONDON, E.C.3.	16414.74.	JOHN G. ALMOND,	TRINIDAD, KINGSTON, From: TAMPOCO, SALTANA, PANAMA. To: <i>Valley</i>

Date of Arrival *21. 6. 1948.*

NAMES AND DESCRIPTIONS OF BRITISH PASSENGERS

(1) Port of Embarkation	(2) Port at which Passengers have been	(3) NAMES OF PASSENGERS	(4) CLASS	(5) AGES OF PASSENGERS	(6) Proposed Address in the United Kingdom	(7) Profession Occupation or Calling	(8) Country of last Residence*	(9) Country of Intended Future Permanent Residence*
				Adults of 15 years and upwards. Children under 15 years. Infants under 2 years.				

Only document: landing cards

The Aftermath

The British **Home Secretary** (Amber Rudd) **resigned**, because these actions were executed by the **Home Office**.

- she denied targeting undocumented immigrants
- leaked documents revealed, that she lied and undocumented immigrants were targeted
- she was accused of misleading parliament, and stepped down

The **hostile environment** policy was heavily disputed with many opposing people.



Final Overview





Thank You!

The Windrush Scandal

25th of November 2025

Sources

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- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Windrush_scandal
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/British_Nationality_Act_1948
- <https://thecommonwealth.org/about/facts>
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- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/HMT_Empire_Windrush
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- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Theresa_May